

Delaware County Redevelopment Commission Meeting January 11th 2024

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=W3xOMVtU0Q0
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Delaware County Redevelopment Commission Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: January 11, 2024

Time: Approximately 9:00 A.M.

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the meeting at approximately 9:00 a.m. on January 11, 2024.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Amber Green, Rob Keasling, Angie Moyer, Bryce Connor.
 - **Absent:** John Adams.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Bryce Connor (following election of officers).

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance.

- **Election of Officers 00:00:50:** Nominations were opened for the Slate of officers.
 - *Nominees:* Bryce Connor (President), Rob Keasling (Vice President), Angie Moyer (Secretary).
 - *Action:* Approved by Voice Vote.
 - **Approval of Minutes 00:01:46:** Approval of prior meeting minutes from December 14, 2023.
 - *Action:* Approved by Voice Vote.
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:02 Resolution 2024-01: Cowan Sidewalk Project**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Danielle
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Funding for sidewalks in downtown Cowan, utilizing the Industrial Center TIF because the project extends into Monroe Township. The project aims to improve pedestrian access and help children walk to the elementary school. An affirmative vote to support this was previously held at the December meeting.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:03:19 Resolution 2024-02: Cowan Incorporation Funding**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Board
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A group of citizens is pursuing the re-incorporation of Cowan as a town (which it was approximately 120-130 years ago) to address local sidewalk and street issues. Funding is requested for due diligence (forming a non-profit corporation) to explore tax rates, obligations, and the impact on the county general fund before making a final commitment.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:04:47 Resolution 2024-03: Gaston Fire Territory**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Board
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed creation of a fire territory involving the Town of Gaston, Harrison Township Trustee, and Washington Township to address funding and service issues for the Gaston fire department, which covers a large area and provides mutual aid across Delaware and Madison counties. Funding supports the initial due diligence process, tax analyses, and required public hearings.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None recorded.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:06:16 Confidentiality Information Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff

- **Deliberation Summary:** Review of an individual agreement for board members regarding confidential economic development project information. Board members were informed that under open records laws, materials reviewed for deliberation are confidential. Once final agreements and incentives are reached, they become public record. Members will sign individual agreements following the meeting.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational item; no formal vote required (individual sign-offs requested).
- **00:08:46 Brownfield Community Outreach Proposal (Industrial Center)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Luke (Mandle Associates / Principal Geist)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented a proposal totaling \$9,870 for continued work following environmental sampling around the industrial center. Findings indicated no widespread soil contamination above screening levels (elevated lead levels found were typical of urban areas near roadways/historic industries), but identified risks of lead in private well plumbing due to natural groundwater corrosivity. The proposal includes creating interactive ArcGIS Story Maps for public education and conducting final outreach to sampled properties.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:17:49 Locker Group Agreement for Services**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Staff / Phil (Locker Group)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposal covers site access engineering, traffic design on Cowan Road, internal roadway design, ADA access, and necessary utilities for a new potential industrial site on South Road involving two lots on the north and south sides of a closed road.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:19:50 Invoices & Bond Invoices**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Staff
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Routine review of general board invoices and bond invoices.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(General floor comments from residents or board members near the conclusion of the meeting.)

- **00:20:29 Board Presentation (James King):** The board presented a plaque honoring Commissioner James King for his distinguished service, hard work, and dedication to the

board.

- **00:30:29 Board Discussion on Social Media / Solar Projects:** Board leadership addressed chatter on Facebook regarding unverified solar projects slated in the county on regional transmission organization (PJM) tracking websites. Clarified that project listing on Pjm's interconnection queue merely indicates developer interest and due diligence, and no official projects have been presented to the Planning and Zoning commissions or County Commissioners.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** None stated outside of ongoing project due diligence.
- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn was made, seconded, and **Approved by Voice Vote** at approximately **00:24:06**.

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